

63.4 THE DEFINITE ARTICLE

The definite article “the” is used to talk about a specific person or thing that everyone understands.

We went on a tour and **the guide** was excellent.

It is clear from the context that this means the tour guide.



When a person or thing has been mentioned already, “the” is used the next time the thing or person is talked about.

There’s a bus trip or a lecture. I’d prefer **the bus trip**.

The bus trip has already been mentioned.



The definite article is used before superlatives.

The Colosseum is probably **the most famous** site in Rome.

Superlative phrase.



The definite article is also used with unique objects.

I’m going to **the Trevi Fountain** before I leave.

There is only one Trevi Fountain.



It is also used for people with unique titles.

The Pope is visiting another country this week.

“Pope” is a title.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

What is **the biggest country** in the world?



I never take **the first train** to work in the morning.



I love this restaurant. **The waiters** are great.



I went to Paris and climbed **the Eiffel Tower**.



Did you buy those shoes from **the shoe shop** on Broad Lane?



The President will be speaking on TV tonight.

